

Assuming the promotion to be adequate, the manufacturer “guessed” that the product itself might be unacceptable. At this point, a consumer survey was taken. The results were surprising. The target consumers were not particularly interested in the baking mix. Instead, the best market turned out to be those families who do their own cooking. They like the convenience of the mix, for preparation of a quick dish when in a hurry.

The original choice of target markets, based upon executive opinion, was in error. It led to an unsuitable plan and wasted promotional expense. This manufacturer, who had tried to reach the wrong markets with a good product, quickly changed his plans after the research facts were in. Preliminary information about consumer thinking might have avoided this costly error.

8.5.3 Online Book on Marketing by Gemmy Allen

<http://ollie.dcccd.edu/mrkt2370/book/mrktbook.htm>

An interactive online hyper book on Marketing by Gemmy Allen is available here for free reference.

The study guide has notes which you can use to periodically check your progress. Study notes also have an outline of the

topics covered, definitions of important terms, objectives and discussion questions, etc. When you click on “review” you get a multiple choice quiz, based on the topics covered in the chapter.



Read one of Gemmy Allen's hyperlink books

Excerpts

Importance of Marketing

The American Marketing Association (AMA) defines marketing as the process of planning and executing the conception, pricing, promotion, and